

As channels scramble in an ever-crowded market, explicit reality shows and a new genre of girl-in-peril soaps compete for viewers' short attention span



THE RATE

By Jhilmil Motihar and Kaveree Bamzai

Ladies and gentlemen. Please scrape your jaws off the floor. Shock TV is here to stay. Already grandfatherly actors are admitting to sleeping with prostitutes on Star Plus's edgy *Sacch ka Saamna*, minor celebrities are having several wet T-shirt moments in Sony's exhibitionist *Iss Jungle se Mujhe Bachao* and Rakhi Sawant is telling her suitors that they're rather "thanda". Brides are being bought in a Bihari family to produce a male heir in Zee TV's *Agle Janam Mohe Bitiya hi Kijo*, girls are being threatened to keep the ghunghat on or it will be hammered

RAKHI KA SWAYAMVAR

NDTV IMAGINE

Will she, won't she marry? An item girl turns Bollywood princess in a show where 16 suitors came calling. Started on June 29, it has an average TRP of 2.3. Now Sawant can say, in her trademark English, thanks God.

